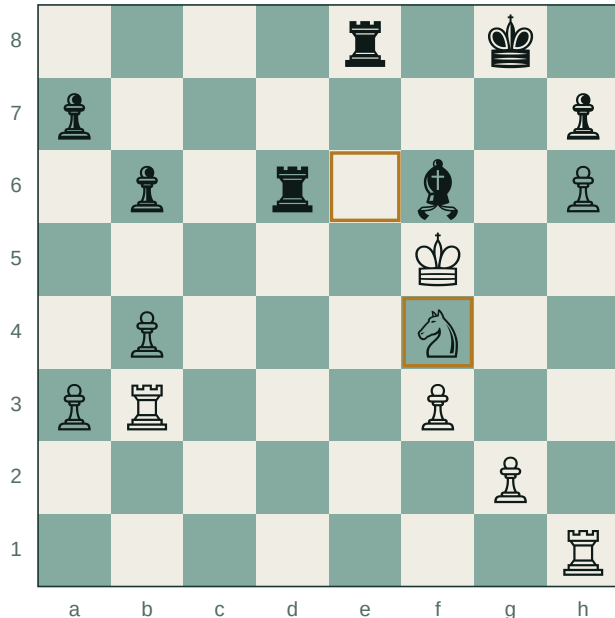


Clearance tactics: Black, move 39

Clearance tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 39.Nxf4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

39...Re5+ 40. Kg4 Rg5+ 41. Kh3 Be5 42. g4 Bxf4

39...Re5+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **40.Kg4**.

40...Rg5+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **41.Kh3**.

41...Be5 The bishop moves from f6 to e5. Recorded reply: **42.g4**.

42...Bxf4 The bishop captures the knight on f4.

At the end, nominal material is White 15 / Black 16 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +3:** the balance goes from -2 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Opening a line helps only if your next move is timely. The defender may close the line or create a stronger threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A clearance move vacates a square or opens a line for another piece. The clearing piece may sacrifice itself to gain the time needed for the follow-up.

HOW TO LOOK

Identify the rook, bishop, queen, or knight that needs access, then locate the friendly piece blocking its route or destination.

The defending king is on f5. Geometrically undefended: rook on b3 and rook on h1. Check for tactical protection.